PART 4

Staff Handbook and Subcontractor Code

Issue 3 · 6 November 2026 · Nicholson Employment Services Limited and Nicholson Construction Limited. The live version is in NicoNet under Company, Staff handbook.

Part A · About Nicholson Everyone

Who we are

Nicholson Group develops, owns, lets and looks after homes in St Helens and Liverpool. We rescue difficult buildings, many of them listed or in town centres, turn them into homes people are proud to live in, and keep them for the long term. We build to hold, not to sell: acquire, transform, operate, hold.

Nicholson HQ is at 105 Water Street, St Helens WA10 1GT. The registered office of our companies is 116 Duke Street, Liverpool L1 5JW.

Nicholson Employment Services Limited (company number 11868444) employs our staff. Nicholson Construction Limited (company number 10427375) engages self-employed subcontractors. Nicholson Lettings Limited lets and manages our homes. The buildings are owned by separate Nicholson property companies. We are registered with the Information Commissioner's Office under number ZC289932.

What we stand for

Our five values are honesty, dependability, reliability, respect, and integrity and ethics. We treat every resident the way we would want to be treated in our own home. We call this Service with Respect.

How we work together is set out in the Nicholson Group Culture Code, in the Company section of NicoNet: pride in everything we do, respect the process, solutions not excuses, one team and one standard, excellence as our default, positivity and professionalism, accountability and trust, a growth mindset, no drama, no blame and no toxicity, and the Nicholson Way. Everyone reads and signs it before their first shift. Sign it, live it, own it.

Our promise to residents: calls answered or returned the same day; every new enquiry called within 60 minutes on weekdays; messages to the office in the Nicholson Living app answered within one working day; messages about a repair answered by the person doing it the same working day; repairs attended within our priority timescales; homes handed over clean, safe and snag-free.

Who gives instructions

Instructions come only from Paul Nicholson (CEO) or Kevin Sharp (Construction Director, Voids & Works Manager), unless Paul Nicholson authorises someone else in writing. Paul Nicholson has authorised Callum Hesketh to deal with HR administration, compliance and certification, uniforms and debt collection.

Everything between you and the Company goes through NicoNet (NicoNet, the app or its web version): instructions, jobs, clocking, holiday and sickness, messages, documents, payslips and notices. In this handbook, "in writing" means through NicoNet. Texts, WhatsApp messages and personal emails are not

used for work. Only if NicoNet is down, phone Kevin Sharp, and record it in NicoNet once it is back.

Your messages go to the office team (Paul Nicholson, Kevin Sharp and Callum Hesketh), who answer them in NicoMGT, the management app, by the end of the working day. Each topic is dealt with by the person responsible for it, shown when you choose the topic. Claude drafts each reply and a member of the office team checks it before it is sent. A reply that changes your work comes from Paul Nicholson or Kevin Sharp. Formal grievances and confidential concerns are not seen by the office team: they go only to Paul Nicholson, or to Kevin Sharp if a grievance is about Paul.

For subcontractors, only Paul Nicholson or Kevin Sharp may issue, vary or cancel a Work Order.

Before your first shift

Nobody works a shift, including a trial shift, until their right to work in the UK has been checked: originals seen in person or on a live video call, a Home Office share code checked online, or an approved digital identity check for British and Irish passports. The check is recorded in NicoNet under Right to work. Where permission is time-limited, NicoNet diarises the follow-up check before it expires. The Company faces a civil penalty of up to £60,000 for each illegal worker, so there are no exceptions.

We do not use unpaid trial shifts. Every hour worked is paid at least the National Minimum Wage. Every employee receives a written statement of terms from Nicholson Employment Services Limited on or before their first day, and any probation period is the one it states. From 1 January 2027 every written statement also tells you of your right to join a trade union. Subcontractors check the right to work of anyone they bring, and we check them too (Part E).

How this handbook works

Part A applies to everyone. Part B applies to employees only. Part C sets the standards for everyone who works on our sites and in our residents' homes, employees and subcontractors alike. Part D explains how we work day to day. Part E applies to self-employed subcontractors only.

For employees, the sections of Part B marked "contractual" form part of your contract of employment, together with your written statement of terms. Everything else in this handbook is company policy and is not contractual. If your written statement and this handbook differ, your written statement applies.

We review this handbook at least once a year. When it changes we will tell you what has changed and ask you to read and sign the new version in NicoNet.

Part B1 · Hours, place of work and attendance

Employees Contractual

Working hours

Your normal working hours are 8:00am to 4:00pm, Monday to Friday. You take a rest break each day at a time that suits the work. Its length, and whether it is paid, is set out in your written statement; it is never less than 20 minutes.

We do not work overtime. You are not required or expected to work beyond 4:00pm. If Paul Nicholson or Kevin Sharp asks you to work extra time and you agree, it must be agreed in advance and is recorded, and it is either paid or given back as time off, as agreed at the time.

Place of work and deployment

You work at Nicholson HQ or at any Nicholson site or property in St Helens, Liverpool and the surrounding area, as directed. You may be asked to work in any team or on any task that is reasonable for your skills. Your team on the organisation chart does not limit your duties.

Clocking in and out

You clock in through NicoNet on arrival at Nicholson HQ or the site you are booked on, by 7:50am at the latest so you are ready to start at 8:00am. You clock out when you leave. NicoNet checks your location only at the moment you press the button, to confirm you are at an authorised place of work. The Location & privacy notice explains how this works.

If you cannot clock in on site, for example because you are collecting materials, use "Ask for a manual clock-in" and say why. Clocking in or out for someone else, or from somewhere other than where you are, is gross misconduct.

Lateness

Clocking in after 7:50am counts as late and is recorded in minutes. If you are going to be late, send Kevin Sharp a message in NicoNet (Messages, Running late) before 7:50am.

Three lates in any four weeks lead to an informal conversation with Kevin Sharp. Further lateness in the three months after that conversation is dealt with under the disciplinary procedure.

Part B2 · Pay, expenses, deductions and pension

Employees

Contractual

Pay

You are paid by bank transfer on the pay day set out in your written statement, by Nicholson Employment Services Limited. Your payslip is in NicoNet under Payslips & P60s on pay day. If anything looks wrong, message Callum Hesketh straight away in NicoNet (Messages, Pay or payslip).

Expenses and purchases

Nothing is bought for the company without a valid order number, requested and approved through Materials & orders. Photograph the receipt in NicoNet the same day. Approved expenses with a receipt are repaid on the following Friday.

Deductions from pay

Tax, National Insurance, pension contributions and any court orders are deducted as the law requires.

By accepting employment you agree that we may also deduct from your pay: (a) any overpayment of wages or expenses; (b) on leaving, pay for holiday taken beyond the holiday you had built up; (c) on leaving, the reasonable cost of company property (keys, tools, uniform, devices) that you have not returned after we have asked for it in writing and given you a reasonable chance to return it; and (d) any other amount you agree to in writing before it is deducted, such as rent for a Nicholson home you live in.

We will not make a deduction that is not listed above, and we will never make a deduction that takes your pay below the National Minimum Wage, except where the law allows it.

We do not fine anyone. Lost keys, uniform, van misuse, lateness and similar breaches are dealt with as conduct matters under Part B7, never by a charge or deduction. Earlier rule books that set fines (THE BIBLE, NicOS, the Team Nico rules and the maintenance rules) are withdrawn.

Pension

Our workplace pension is with Smart Pension. If you are eligible, Nicholson Employment Services Limited automatically enrols you from your first day, and we pay the employer contributions the law requires. If you are not automatically enrolled, you can ask to join at any time by messaging Callum Hesketh in NicoNet, and we will enrol you within one month. Your contributions are shown on your payslip.

Staying in the pension is your decision. If you want to opt out, you do it yourself directly with Smart Pension, using their opt-out notice, within one month of being enrolled; your contributions are then refunded. We cannot opt you out, process an opt-out for you, or advise you whether to opt out, and nobody at Nicholson will encourage you to leave the scheme. If you opt out, or stop contributing, you can ask to rejoin at any time.

The law requires us to re-enrol everyone who has opted out every three years, on our re-enrolment date. You will be told in writing when this happens, and you can opt out again if you choose. We keep opt-out notices and pension records for the periods the Pensions Regulator requires.

Part B3 · Holidays

Employees · Contractual

How much holiday

The holiday year runs from 1 January to 31 December. A full-time employee gets 20 days' paid holiday plus the 8 bank holidays in England, which are also paid: 28 days, or 5.6 weeks, in total. Part-time employees get the same pro rata. In your first holiday year, holiday builds up at one-twelfth of the yearly amount at the start of each month.

If you work on a bank holiday at our request, you get a paid day off in lieu.

Booking holiday

Request holiday in NicoNet. Give at least two weeks' notice, or notice of twice the length of the holiday if that is longer. Paul Nicholson or Callum Hesketh approves or declines. We can decline a request by giving you notice equal to the length of the holiday requested, and we will always try to agree another date. Do not book travel until your holiday is approved. More than two weeks in a row needs Paul Nicholson's approval.

We may require everyone to take holiday on particular days, for example over Christmas, by giving at least twice as many days' notice as the days to be taken. Any shutdown is announced in Staff events.

Carrying holiday over

Please take all your holiday in the year. We remind you of your balance and encourage you to take it. Holiday not taken by 31 December is lost, except: holiday you could not take because of sickness or maternity, paternity, adoption or other family leave, which you may carry over as the law provides; holiday you could not take because we did not give you a reasonable opportunity; and up to 5 days that Paul Nicholson agrees in writing may be carried into January to March.

If you are sick during booked holiday, report it in NicoNet under Sickness that day and you can take the holiday another time.

When you leave

We pay you for holiday you have built up but not taken. If you have taken more than you have built up, the difference is deducted from your final pay (Part B2).

Part B4 · Sickness and absence

Employees Contractual

Reporting sickness

If you are too ill to work, report it in NicoNet under Sickness by 7:30am on the first day. It goes straight to Kevin Sharp and Paul Nicholson. A text or WhatsApp message is not a sickness report. Update the same record each day unless a fit note covers the period, and upload any fit note there. Only if NicoNet is down, phone Kevin Sharp.

Evidence

For absences of up to 7 days in a row (counting weekends and bank holidays), you self-certify in NicoNet. From the eighth day you need a fit note, which can be issued by a doctor, nurse, pharmacist, occupational therapist or physiotherapist. We do not ask for prescriptions or details of medication.

Sick pay

If you are eligible, you are paid Statutory Sick Pay from the first day of sickness. There is no company sick pay unless your written statement says otherwise.

Return to work

After every absence, however short, you complete a return-to-work form with your manager on your first day back. It is a chance to check you are fit, agree any support or adjustments, and update your record.

Attendance reviews

Frequent short absences cause the most disruption. We keep an absence score for the last 52 weeks: the number of absences, multiplied by itself, multiplied by the total days absent. A score of 51 or more leads to an informal conversation with your manager. 125 or more leads to a formal attendance meeting, which may result in a first written warning. 250 or more leads to a second formal meeting, which may result in a final written warning. 400 or more leads to a final review, which may result in dismissal.

These points prompt a review; they are not automatic sanctions. Every review looks at the reasons for the absence and what support would help. Absence related to disability, pregnancy or maternity, and absence agreed as a reasonable adjustment, is not counted against you. You have the right to be accompanied at every formal meeting.

Part B5 · Family leave and other time off Employees

Your entitlements

You are entitled to the statutory family leave and time off the law provides, with the pay and eligibility rules in force at the time. This includes: paid time off for antenatal appointments; maternity leave of up to 52 weeks and Statutory Maternity Pay; adoption leave and pay; paternity leave and pay; shared parental leave and pay; neonatal care leave; unpaid parental leave of up to 18 weeks for each child before their 18th birthday; unpaid carer's leave; reasonable unpaid time off to deal with an emergency involving a dependant; and parental bereavement leave.

If you are called for jury service, message Paul Nicholson in NicoNet as soon as you receive the summons and upload it. The time is unpaid by us; you claim loss of earnings from the court.

Message Paul Nicholson in NicoNet as early as you can, so we can plan cover and confirm exactly what you are entitled to.

Flexible working

You can ask to change your hours, the times you work or where you work from your first day of employment. Send your request in writing through NicoNet (Messages, Family leave, jury service or time off), addressed to Paul Nicholson, saying what you would like to change and from when. You can make up to two requests in any 12 months.

We will consider every request seriously, and before we refuse one we will meet you to talk it through. You may be accompanied by a colleague. We will give you our decision in writing within two months of your request, including any appeal, unless we agree a longer time with you. We will refuse only for one of the business reasons the law allows, and we will tell you which one and why. You may appeal in writing within five working days of the decision.

Part B6 · Performance, appraisals and feedback Employees

1-2-1s and appraisals

You can ask for a 1-2-1 with Paul Nicholson or Kevin Sharp at any time through NicoNet. Callum Hesketh does not hold 1-2-1s; send pay, holiday and paperwork queries to him through Messages.

Everyone has an appraisal in January, covering the previous calendar year, and a check-in in July. Kevin Sharp appraises the trades, maintenance and construction teams; Paul Nicholson appraises Kevin Sharp and Callum Hesketh. You complete a self-appraisal in NicoNet first. You and your manager score eight areas on one scale (Outstanding, Standard, Developing, Unsatisfactory), agree objectives and training for the coming year, and both sign the record. You can see your record at any time.

Attendance is scored excluding any absence related to disability, pregnancy or maternity.

When performance falls short

If your work falls below the standard expected, your manager will first talk to you informally and agree a written improvement plan with support and a fair period to improve. If that does not work, the formal stages of the disciplinary procedure apply, with the same rights to be told the concerns in advance, to be accompanied and to appeal.

Recognition and feedback

Each month we name an Employee of the Month. Anyone can nominate a colleague in NicoNet. Each month you can also give anonymous feedback on how things are going and how we could improve.

Part B7 · Conduct, disciplinary, grievance and whistleblowing

Employees

Disciplinary procedure

This procedure follows the ACAS Code of Practice on disciplinary and grievance procedures. Minor issues are dealt with informally first.

Formal steps: the facts are investigated; you are told in writing what the allegation is, given the evidence, and invited to a hearing with at least two working days' notice; you may be accompanied by a colleague or a trade union representative; the decision is confirmed in writing; you may appeal in writing within five working days, and the appeal is heard by someone not previously involved where possible, or by an independent HR adviser.

Outcomes: a first written warning (on file for 6 months), a final written warning (on file for 12 months), or dismissal with notice. Gross misconduct may lead to dismissal without notice. You may be suspended on full pay while serious allegations are investigated; suspension is not a punishment.

Gross misconduct

Examples include: theft, fraud or dishonesty; falsifying a clock-in, timesheet, job record or expense claim; violence, bullying or harassment; discrimination; being unfit for work through alcohol or drugs; serious breach of health and safety rules or refusing to wear required PPE; copying, sharing or misusing keys, door codes or residents' personal data; entering a resident's home without authority; serious damage to company property; using company vehicles for private use without permission; serious insubordination; and bringing the company into serious disrepute.

Grievances

If you have a concern about your work, colleagues or how you have been treated, raise it informally with your manager first. If that does not resolve it, send it in NicoNet (Messages, Formal grievance) to Paul Nicholson, or to Kevin Sharp if your grievance is about Paul. We will meet you within five working days, you may be accompanied, we will confirm the outcome in writing, and you may appeal within five working days.

Whistleblowing

If you believe something unlawful, dangerous or dishonest is happening at work, tell Paul Nicholson through NicoNet (Messages, Confidential concern), which only he can see. You will not suffer any detriment for raising a genuine concern, including a concern about sexual harassment. You can also report to the relevant regulator, such as the Health and Safety Executive, HMRC or the Information Commissioner's Office.

Part B8 · Equality, dignity at work and your data Employees

Equality

We do not discriminate on the grounds of age, disability, gender reassignment, marriage or civil partnership, pregnancy or maternity, race, religion or belief, sex or sexual orientation, in recruitment, pay, training, promotion, discipline or any other decision. Tell us if you need an adjustment because of a disability and we will make reasonable adjustments.

Harassment, including sexual harassment

Harassment, sexual harassment, bullying and victimisation are not tolerated, whether by a colleague, a manager, a subcontractor, a supplier, a resident, a visitor or a member of the public. Harassment is unwanted conduct related to a protected characteristic (age, disability, gender reassignment, race, religion or belief, sex or sexual orientation) that violates your dignity or creates an intimidating, hostile, degrading, humiliating or offensive environment. Sexual harassment is unwanted conduct of a sexual nature, including comments, jokes, messages, images, touching and requests. Treating someone worse because they rejected or submitted to it is also harassment.

The law requires us to take all reasonable steps to prevent sexual harassment of our staff, and to prevent harassment of our staff by third parties such as residents, visitors and suppliers. We do that through a written harassment risk assessment, reviewed at least once a year and after any incident; harassment awareness training for every employee at induction and every year, with additional training for managers; this policy, which everyone signs; clear warnings to residents in the Nicholson Living app and the Service with Respect page; and the controls in Part C for working in residents' homes.

If you are harassed, or you see it happen to someone else, report it in NicoNet (Messages, Confidential concern), which only Paul Nicholson sees. If it concerns Paul, raise it as a formal grievance, which goes to Kevin Sharp, or report it to Kevin Sharp in person. You can also raise it as a formal grievance under Part B7. Every report is taken seriously, investigated promptly and kept as confidential as the investigation allows. You will not suffer any detriment for reporting in good faith.

If you feel unsafe in a resident's home or on a site, leave straight away and report it. You will not be sent back alone. Where a resident or other third party is responsible, we will act, which may include a written warning, attending only in pairs or by appointment, action under the tenancy, or reporting to the police. Harassment by an employee is gross misconduct under Part B7.

Your personal data

We keep your personnel records, pay records, absence records and the location recorded when you clock in and out. Health information is seen only by Paul Nicholson and, for administration, Callum Hesketh. Personnel records are kept for six years after you leave; clock-in locations for 12 months. The Location & privacy notice at the foot of NicoNet explains this in full.

Part B9 · Notice and leaving Employees Contractual

Notice

Notice periods are set out in your written statement and are never less than the legal minimum. From us, that is one week after one month's service, rising by one week for each complete year of service up to 12 weeks. From you, it is at least one week.

Leaving

Before your last day, return all keys, fobs, tools, uniform, PPE, devices, fuel cards and vehicles. Your NicoNet login is switched off on your last day. Your final pay includes any holiday you have built up and not taken (Part B3).

Part B10 · Drugs and alcohol Employees Contractual

The rule

You must not work, drive for work or come on to a site or into a resident's home under the influence of alcohol or drugs, or with them in your possession. Tell Paul Nicholson in confidence, through Messages (Confidential concern, which only he sees), about any prescribed or over-the-counter medicine that could affect your safety at work; it will be treated as health information.

Testing

Because our work involves sites, tools, heights, electricity and driving, everyone in a site, maintenance, construction or driving role may be tested at random, without notice. Anyone may be tested where there is reasonable cause to suspect they are unfit, and after an accident or serious near miss. Office roles are tested only for cause or after an incident. Testing applies to everyone in a covered role in the same way.

Tests are carried out in private by a trained person or an external provider using approved kits. A non-negative result is sent for a laboratory confirmation test, and you may ask for the split sample to be tested independently. Results are health information: they are seen only by Paul Nicholson, recorded in a restricted record and kept for 12 months, or for as long as any disciplinary process that uses them requires. A data protection impact assessment covers this policy.

You are asked to sign the Drugs and Alcohol Testing addendum to your contract before any test. It replaces the addendum dated 13 April 2025.

If a test is positive or refused

You will be removed from site straight away and taken home; you will not be allowed to drive. You will normally be suspended on full pay while the matter is investigated under Part B7. A confirmed positive test, refusing a test without good reason or tampering with a sample may be gross misconduct.

Getting help

If you think you have a drug or alcohol problem and tell Paul Nicholson before you are asked to take a test, it will be treated as a health matter: we will support you to get help and agree time off for treatment where we can. That does not apply once a test has been requested or after an incident.

Part C · Standards on our sites and in residents' homes Everyone

Health and safety

Before your first day on any site, read and sign its site induction and RAMS in NicoNet. Follow them, the construction phase plan and site rules. Only use tools, plant and access equipment you are trained and authorised to use, and keep your tickets current in Training & tickets. Wear the PPE the RAMS require. Stop work and report it if you find suspected asbestos or anything unsafe. You have the right to stop unsafe work.

Report every accident, near miss and unsafe condition in NicoNet the same day. If you work alone in an empty property, use Lone working. Never work under the influence of alcohol or drugs.

In residents' homes

Residents get at least 24 hours' written notice of a visit through the Nicholson Living app, unless it is an emergency or they ask us to come sooner. Wear your ID, introduce yourself and offer to wear shoe covers. Protect floors and furniture, keep noise and disruption down, clean up, and leave the home secure.

If a resident behaves inappropriately, makes you feel unsafe or harasses you, leave straight away and report it in NicoNet the same day. Homes flagged by management are visited only in pairs or by appointment, and you are told before the visit.

If a resident refuses access, do not force entry; leave and report it. Do not take any payment from a resident. Do not discuss rents, other residents or company business. Do not smoke or vape in any home, communal area or company vehicle.

If a resident reports a repair to you directly, log it in NicoNet for them straight away. A repair is never ignored because of how it was reported.

Messaging residents about a job

When a repair is allocated to you, the resident can message you about it in the Nicholson Living app, and you reply from the job in NicoNet (My jobs). You each see the other's first name only. Phone numbers, email addresses and social media are never exchanged, and the conversation never moves to texts, WhatsApp or calls.

Reply the same working day. A message not answered by the end of the working day is escalated automatically to Kevin Sharp.

Claude checks every reply before it is sent. Type what you want to say or choose a quick reply (on my way, running late, access, job complete); Claude puts it into the Nicholson house style and you see the final wording before it goes. A reply that mentions rent, arrears, deposits, notice, compensation, cost or blame, another resident, or any contact details is held and passed to the office instead.

Keep to your job: when you are coming, access, what you are doing, what you found, what you did and what you need from the resident. Everything else goes to the office through Messages the same day: complaints, so Callum Hesketh can log them, and any change to the job's scope, date or priority, for Kevin Sharp. Never agree extra work, promise a date you cannot keep, or take payment.

Write as you would speak to the resident at their door: polite, short and factual. Never argue. If a resident is rude or abusive, do not reply; flag the conversation to Kevin Sharp and the office takes it over. Emergencies are never dealt with in messages: the resident is directed to the emergency line.

Every message is kept on the job record and can be read by the resident, the office, the council, the ombudsman and the courts.

Standard of work

Every job is finished to a snag-free, handover-ready standard. The job record says what the issue was, what you found and what you did, with before and after photos and the materials used. Never mark a job complete that is not.

Vehicles, keys and company property

Do the daily van check before the first journey and report defects the same day. If you drive for work, keep your vehicle declaration up to date. Company vans are clean inside and out, carry only company stock and are never smoked or vaped in. Parking and traffic fines incurred while driving are the driver's own responsibility and are reported in NicoNet the day they arrive.

Every key is numbered and tagged and is signed out and back in through Keys & tools the same day. Keys are never left in a van, taken home (unless Kevin Sharp has authorised an out-of-hours call-out) or copied without Kevin Sharp's authority. Report a lost key straight away so the lock can be changed. Kevin Sharp audits the key register every quarter.

Company tools and equipment stay company property and are signed out through Keys & tools.

Uniform, ID and PPE

Uniform, ID card and PPE are issued free through Uniform & PPE. Wear the full, clean uniform and visible ID on every job, and the PPE the RAMS require on every site. Report loss or damage the same day and it will be replaced. Return everything when you leave.

Passwords, codes and devices

Door codes, alarm codes, WiFi passwords, PINs and system logins are never written in documents, notes, photos, texts or chats. They are held only in the Company password manager; ask Kevin Sharp if you need one for a job. Report a lost phone, tablet or laptop the same day so it can be locked and wiped. Personnel records and key registers are never left on view.

Confidentiality and social media

Keep residents' personal data, our finances and company business confidential. Photographs taken at work are uploaded only to NicoNet. Do not post about our buildings, residents or colleagues on social media without Paul Nicholson's written permission.

Part D · How we work Everyone

Repairs

Residents report repairs in the Nicholson Living app. Emergency repairs are made safe within 24 hours and completed within 2 days; reactive repairs within 14 days; inconvenience repairs within 28 days. The maintenance team completes at least 5 jobs a day. Each job is booked on the Maintenance calendar and appears in My jobs. The resident can message the person allocated to the job about it (Part C). When you close a job, the resident is told what was done and by whom and asked for feedback. The Reactive Maintenance Operating System (RMOS) has the full procedure.

Voids and move-ins

Every void follows SOP-V01 and its forms in NicoNet: check-out inspections 4 weeks and 2 weeks before the tenant leaves, final check-out at 11:00am on the last day, move-in prep, the non-negotiables, cleaning, the quality audit and the move-in meeting. Move-ins are between 3:00pm and 5:00pm. No home is released for letting until the quality audit passes.

Materials and spending

Every purchase needs a valid order number from Materials & orders. Any outside contractor job over £100 needs three quotes and Paul Nicholson's approval. Furniture is used only with management's approval.

Compliance and inspections

Callum Hesketh owns the compliance calendar: gas safety records every year, electrical installation condition reports every five years, EPCs, fire risk assessments, alarm and emergency lighting servicing, the Nicholson Mansion HMO licence and Liverpool selective licences. Kevin Sharp owns property inspections: one block a week, plus move-in and move-out inspections. Weekly fire alarm tests are logged in Compliance & audits.

Meetings

The team meets every Monday to review the week ahead, and everyone sets three goals for the week. Progress against them is reported in NicoNet on Friday. Everyone contributes. Minutes are factual and neutral: nothing derogatory about a resident or a colleague is ever written in a minute, a job record or a message.

Bring problems with the options and your recommendation. Capital spend, rent and arrears decisions, development progress and any complaint that reaches stage 2 go to Paul Nicholson.

Residents and customer service

Resident messages to the office in the Nicholson Living app are answered within one working day. Messages about a repair are answered by the person allocated to it the same working day (Part C). If you are going to be late for an appointment, tell the resident in the job's messages before the appointment time. Never promise what you cannot deliver; if a mistake is made, put it right and say so.

Resident complaints

Any complaint, however it arrives, is passed to Callum Hesketh through Messages the same day so it is logged. Stage 1: the person responsible (Kevin Sharp for repairs and works; Callum Hesketh for lettings, rent and arrears) acknowledges it through the app within 3 working days and gives a full written response within 10 working days of acknowledging it, or explains the delay and gives a new date. Stage 2: if the resident is not satisfied, Paul Nicholson reviews it, offers a meeting and gives the final written response within 10 working days. The final response tells the resident how to refer the complaint to the redress scheme named in their tenancy information.

Lettings rules since 1 May 2026

We do not offer viewings. Homes are let at the advertised rent: we do not invite or accept offers above it. We do not refuse anyone because they have children or receive benefits. A holding deposit is no more than one week's rent and a tenancy deposit no more than five weeks'; both are handled only by Paul Nicholson and Callum Hesketh, and every deposit is protected. We take no other payment from a resident:

no key deposits, call-out charges, fees or compulsory contents insurance. Tenancies are periodic and possession is sought only on the statutory grounds, through Paul Nicholson. Damp and mould reports are never closed without an inspection and a written outcome to the resident.

Part F · Health and safety policy Everyone

Statement of intent

This is the health and safety policy of Nicholson Employment Services Limited, which employs our staff, and Nicholson Construction Limited, which engages our subcontractors, for all work carried out for Nicholson Group on our sites, in our offices and in our residents' homes. It is made under section 2(3) of the Health and Safety at Work etc. Act 1974.

We will, so far as is reasonably practicable: provide and maintain safe places of work, safe plant and equipment and safe systems of work; assess the risks of our work and put the controls in place; consult our staff on health and safety; give everyone the information, instruction, training and supervision they need; provide personal protective equipment free of charge; prevent accidents and work-related ill health; and protect our residents, visitors and the public from the risks of our work. We will meet the requirements of the Construction (Design and Management) Regulations 2015 on every project.

Signed: Paul Nicholson, Chief Executive, for Nicholson Employment Services Limited and Nicholson Construction Limited. 3 November 2026. This policy is reviewed at least once a year, and whenever our work, our organisation or the law changes significantly.

Organisation: who is responsible

Paul Nicholson (Chief Executive) has overall responsibility for health and safety, for providing the resources it needs, for this policy and its annual review, and for reporting under RIDDOR. He obtains competent health and safety advice where the work needs it.

Kevin Sharp (Construction Director, Voids & Works Manager) is responsible day to day for health and safety on every site, void and maintenance job: risk assessments and method statements (RAMS), the construction phase plan, site inductions, supervision, plant and equipment, PPE, accident investigation, toolbox talks and site inspections.

Callum Hesketh is responsible for keeping health and safety records in NicoNet: training and tickets, inductions and sign-offs, the accident book, property compliance certificates, fire alarm test logs and the employers' liability insurance certificate.

Everyone who works for us must take reasonable care of their own health and safety and that of others, follow this policy, the RAMS and site rules, use equipment and PPE properly, report accidents, near misses and hazards the same day, and stop any work they believe is unsafe.

Arrangements: how we do it

Risk assessment: Kevin Sharp makes sure a suitable and sufficient risk assessment and method statement exists for every task before it starts, including working at height, manual handling, hazardous substances (COSHH), electricity, asbestos, dust, noise and vibration, hot works, plant and lone working. Assessments are recorded in NicoNet, explained to everyone doing the work and reviewed when the work changes or after an incident. Pregnant workers and new or young workers have an individual assessment.

Construction work: on every project we identify the client, principal designer and principal contractor duties under CDM 2015, prepare a construction phase plan before work starts, notify the HSE where the project is notifiable, and provide welfare facilities on site from the first day.

Asbestos: no intrusive work starts in a building built before 2000 until an asbestos survey or the asbestos register for that area has been checked. Anyone who finds suspected asbestos stops work, leaves the area and reports it.

Training and competence: every new starter and subcontractor completes the site induction before starting, and everyone holds the cards and tickets their work needs (for example CSCS, PASMA, IPAF, asbestos awareness, first aid). Toolbox talks are held regularly and recorded.

Equipment and vehicles: tools, access equipment and plant are inspected before use and maintained; scaffolds and towers are inspected and tagged; portable electrical equipment is checked; vans have a daily check. Defects are reported the same day and the item is taken out of use.

First aid, accidents and RIDDOR: every site and Nicholson HQ has a first aid kit and a trained first aider or appointed person. Every accident, near miss and dangerous occurrence is recorded in NicoNet the same day and investigated. Paul Nicholson reports to the HSE the injuries, diseases and dangerous occurrences RIDDOR requires, within its time limits.

Fire and emergencies: every site and building has a fire risk assessment, escape routes kept clear, and a sign-in register so we know who is on site. Weekly fire alarm tests are logged in NicoNet.

Lone working and residents' homes: anyone working alone uses Lone working in NicoNet. Homes flagged for risk are visited only in pairs or by appointment.

Consultation and information: we consult staff on health and safety at Monday meetings and toolbox talks, and anyone can raise a concern at any time through NicoNet. The Health and Safety Executive's "Health and safety law: what you need to know" poster is displayed at Nicholson HQ and on every site, and a copy is in NicoNet. Our employers' liability insurance certificate is displayed at Nicholson HQ and in NicoNet.

Monitoring: Kevin Sharp inspects sites and properties regularly and records the findings. Paul Nicholson reviews accidents, near misses, inspections and this policy at least once a year.

Part E · Subcontractor Code Subcontractors

Your status

You work for Nicholson Construction Limited as an independent business under the Self Employed Subcontractor Framework Agreement. You are not an employee. Our staff procedures on hours, holidays, sickness, appraisals and discipline do not apply to you.

Work Orders

Work is offered as a Work Order in NicoNet, setting out the site, scope, price or rate, start date and site access hours. You are free to accept or decline any Work Order. Once you accept, you decide how to carry out the work, within the specification, the RAMS and the site rules. Only Paul Nicholson or Kevin Sharp may issue or vary a Work Order.

You may send a suitably qualified substitute or bring an assistant, at your own cost, provided they meet the competence, safety and right-to-work requirements and you tell Kevin Sharp in advance through NicoNet (Messages, Substitute or assistant).

If you cannot attend work you have accepted, message Kevin Sharp in NicoNet as early as possible so the site can be planned.

Site sign-in

Sign in and out through NicoNet when you arrive at and leave a site. This is the site safety and fire register, not a timesheet. Site access hours are set by the site, neighbours and residents; they are not working hours.

Tools, PPE, insurance and tickets

You supply your own tools, transport, workwear and standard PPE. Site-specific safety equipment the RAMS require may be provided on site. You keep public liability insurance of at least £5 million (or the amount stated in the Work Order), employers' liability insurance if you employ or engage others, and the trade cards and tickets your work needs, and keep copies current in NicoNet.

Invoices and payment

Invoice each week by 12:00 noon on Monday for the week before, through Work orders & invoices, with labour, materials, plant and consumables shown separately and receipts for materials. Where we have agreed self-billing, we raise the invoice for you from your accepted Work Orders. We deduct CIS tax at the rate HMRC confirms (gross, 20% or 30%) and give you a monthly CIS statement. Payment is made by bank transfer to your verified account in line with the framework agreement.

Site and home standards

Part C of this handbook applies to you as the site rules for working on our sites and in residents' homes. Removal from a site for safety, security, quality or contractual reasons is a site-control measure under your agreement, not a disciplinary process.

As a condition of site access, you and anyone you bring may be asked to take a drugs and alcohol test on the same basis as our employees (random for site work, for cause, and after an accident). Refusing or failing a test means removal from site.